

"I am not sure whether the next one is a challenge or just a misconception, but many organisations feel that implementing IIoT can be a costly affair. We need to understand that not all stages require implementing IIoT at one go. The companies can do so in a stage-by-stage manner. The focus should be on the convergence of IT and OT. Aligning smart manufacturing is a work in process and rethinking flow of operations is management's task to assess," adds Manish Misra.

"The cost of implementing IIoT for an SME like us goes up exponentially when legacy and modern machines are considered collaboratively. Another challenge is the set of people who believe that they manufacture efficiently without having these fancy processes in place," notes Vinod Sharma.

Traceability: The big advantage

"IIoT is all about scale and pricing. As someone who supplies PCB as a component, AT&S needs to make sure that these have the reliability at competitive pricing. The most important thing is quality. We ensure quality from a customer's point of view using the traceability and data systems verticals of IIoT. We have seen tremendous results in the past," says Sunil Banwari.

"From a customer's point of view, they want a peace of mind with every single unit of PCB we deliver to them. Having the information systems in place ensure that the traceability does not get missed. If there are errors in a PCB, we can trace down the entire lot for the customer so that the customer does not need to shut its entire operations," adds Sunil Banwari.

A detailed report by Deloitte mentioned that distributed ledger technologies (blockchain technology) and IoT have the potential to solve important glitches in traceability and provenance challenges. In fact, in Deloitte's 2013 global supply chain risk survey, almost two thirds (63 per cent) of respondents identified risk in the extended value chain—comprising vendors and customers—as their greatest concern with regards to supply chain risk.

"In many cases, we have been able

to have professionals from our sites outside India log in and troubleshoot problems for us and our customers. IIoT, undoubtedly, creates a field where internal communication as well as external communication is in real time. The problems get solved on a real-time basis. Additionally, it helps all our facilities and, in some cases, our customers as well, to address problems collaboratively," points out Sunil Banwari.

Creating jobs or killing them?

Automation means the removal of humans and their intervention. So, is it correct to assume that IIoT will spell a lot of job losses? Interestingly, all spokespersons believed that IIoT would actually create new jobs. The requirement for professionals is to reskill and upskill themselves and embrace the revolution that is taking place in the IIoT industry. Arpit Chhabra, CEO, IoTfy, notes that individuals will have to play active roles in innovating new manufacturing processes.

"When computers were introduced into the banking system, a lot of people started fearing job losses. However, more high-paying jobs got introduced. The same will happen with IIoT. The value-addition that a human can do is going to add new avenues for people who are otherwise doing repetitive work. IIoT is not going to have any impact on the job scenario. As a matter of fact, a company that is introducing IIoT to its manufacturing process is going to witness a positive impact on the quality produced," concludes Arpit Chhabra.

China, the United States, and Western Europe, as per the latest IDC report, will account for roughly three-quarters of all IoT spending throughout the forecast. Although the three regions will have similar spending totals initially, China's spending will grow at a faster rate than the other two regions—13.4 per cent CAGR compared to nine per cent and 11.4 per cent—enabling it to become the dominant region for IoT spending. The fastest IoT spending growth will be in the Middle East and Africa, Central and Eastern Europe, and Latin America regions. The report does not mention India anywhere. **EFY**



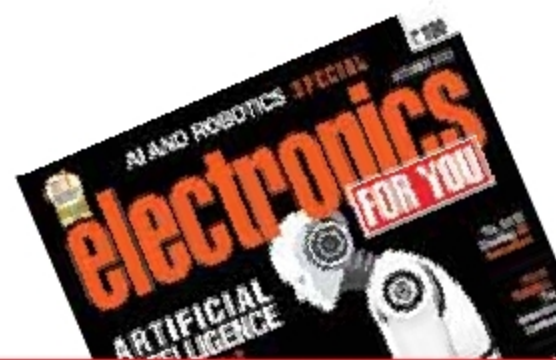
Don't Be A Loser!

You don't know how much you don't know.

Read

electronics FOR YOU

to keep up-to-date with the tech world



To subscribe, visit efy.in or contact us at: 011-4059660 Email: support@efy.in

OR Scan This Code



Also available at all leading magazine outlets